4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: December 2025. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

December 2025 Locked December 2025 is locked (closed 5 Jan 2026). These numbers won't change.

In short: Jobs made a 43.7% gross margin in December: maintenance contracts the most (63.8%), installations the least (31.6%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

December's jobs made $65,657 gross margin (43.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $22,821 and overheads $57,350, leaving ($14,514) profit before tax ((9.7%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 53.3% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$65,657
Technician wages and on-costs	$65,117
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$42,296
Technician time not charged to jobs	$22,821
Gross profit (the P&L)	$42,836
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$57,350
Profit before tax (the P&L)	($14,514)
Revenue	$150,283
Gross margin on jobs, %	43.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(9.7%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**53.3%**

Type of job: All jobs

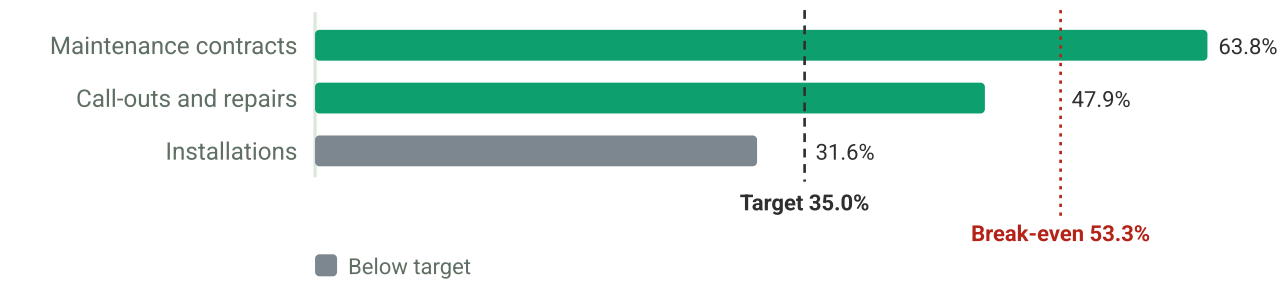
Job gross margin, December · All jobs
43.7%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, November · All jobs
40.5%
target 35.0%

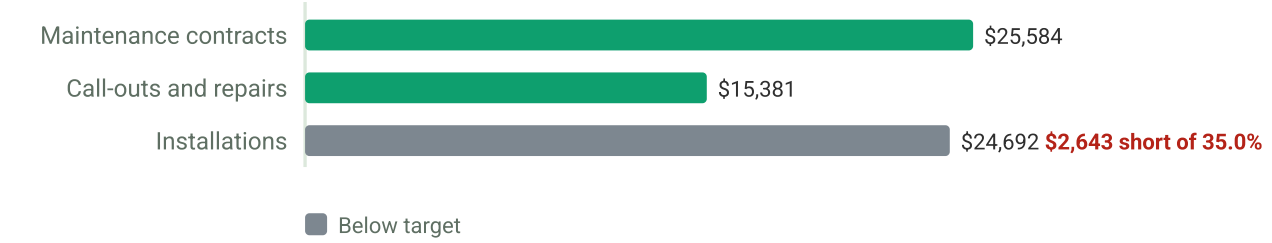
Gross margin jobs need to break even
53.3%
covers overheads and time not charged (December)

Job gross margin by type of job, December 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In December maintenance contracts made a 63.8% job gross margin, installations made a 31.6% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 47.9% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 53.3% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 31.6% gross margin, 3.4 points under the 35.0% target: about $2,643 on $78,100 of revenue in December. It's below the 53.3% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in December).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

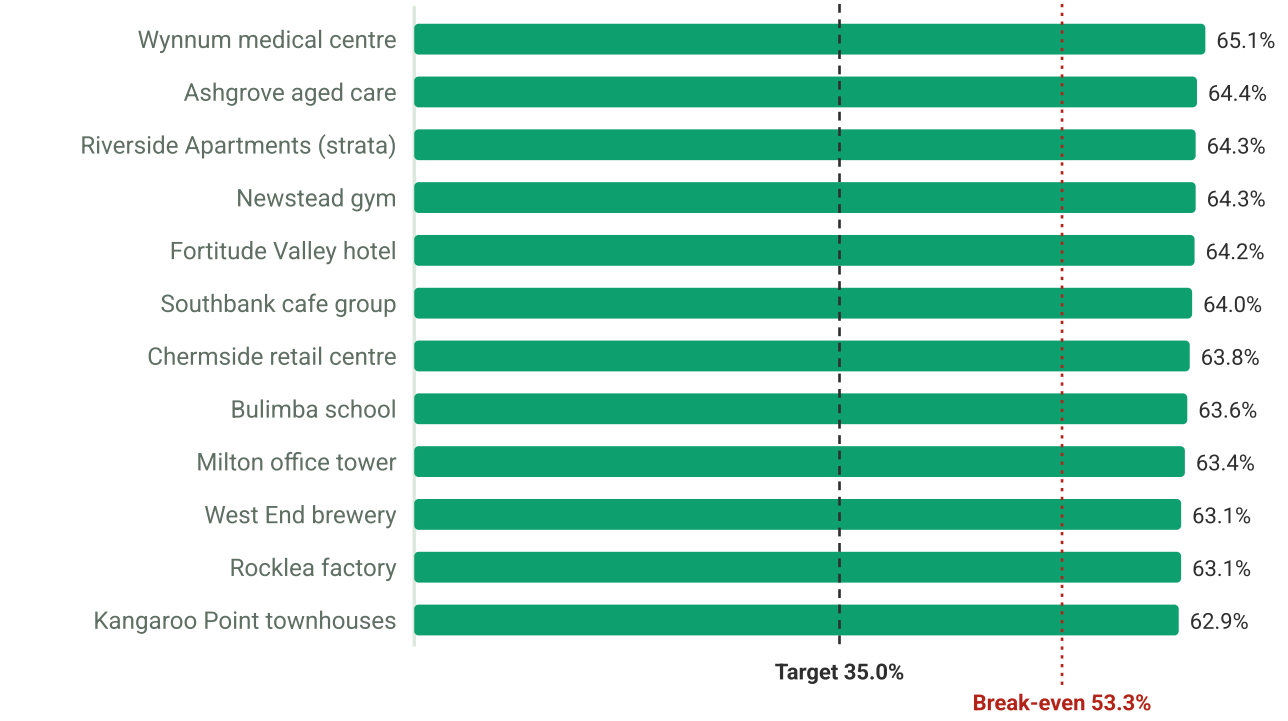
Job gross margin, December · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, November · Maintenance contracts
63.8%
target 35.0%

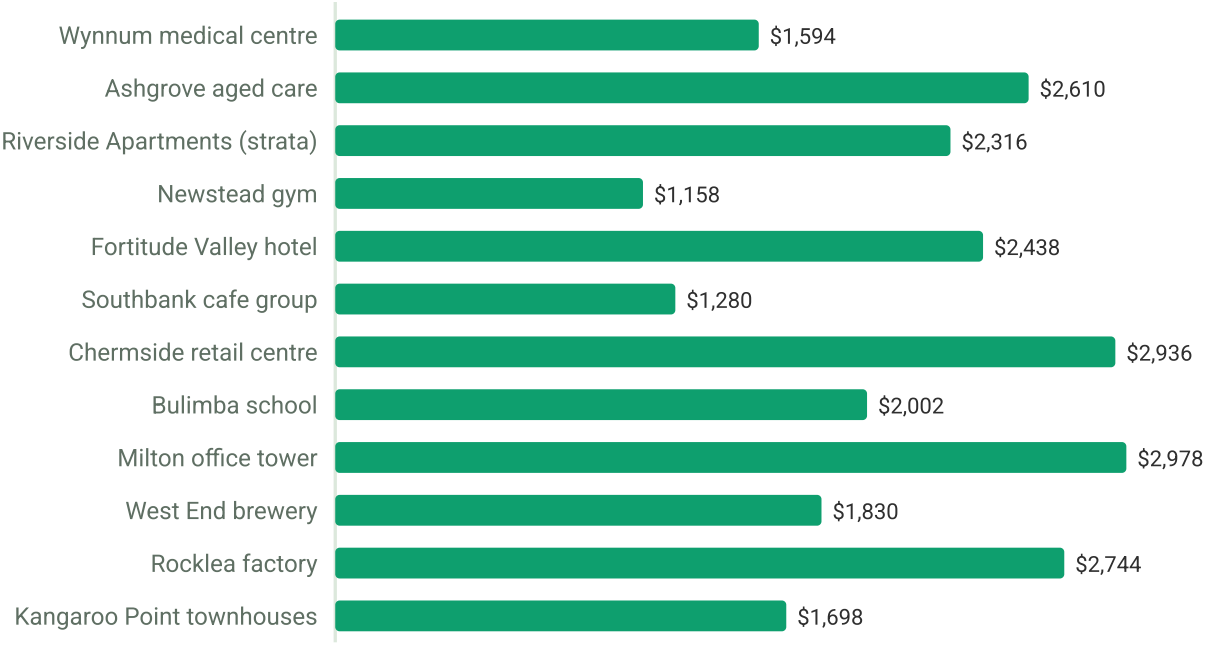
Gross margin jobs need to break even
53.3%
covers overheads and time not charged (December)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, December 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 12 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in December). All maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($11,549 ahead on $40,100 in December).

Type of job: Installations

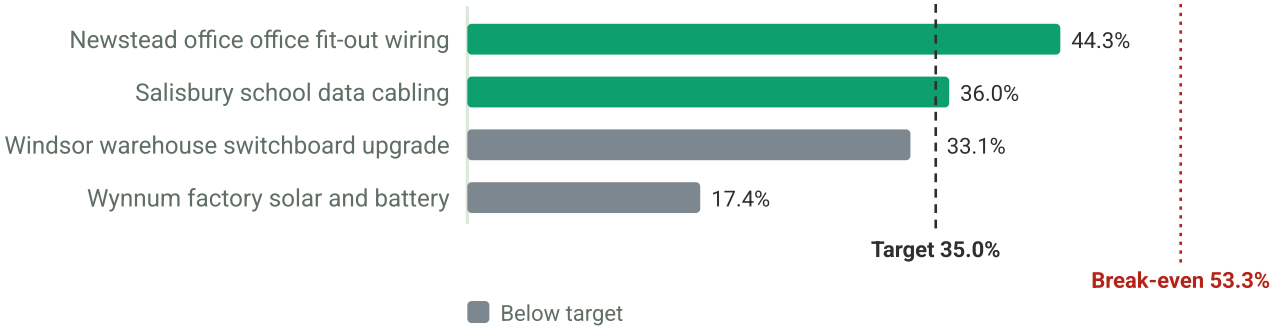
Job gross margin, December · Installations
31.6%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, November · Installations
31.3%
target 35.0%

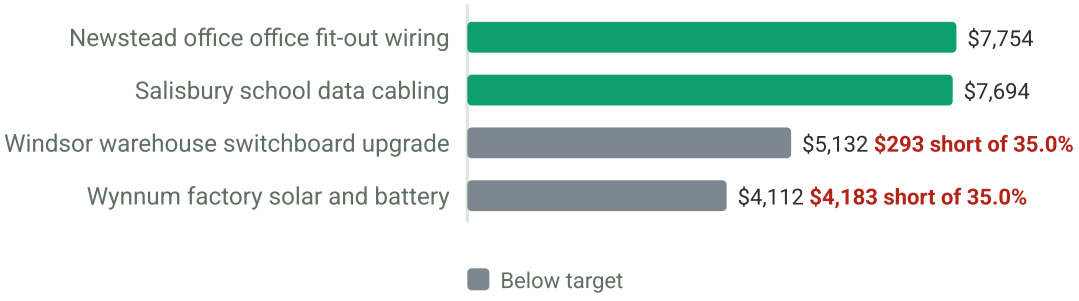
Gross margin jobs need to break even
53.3%
covers overheads and time not charged (December)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in December 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

2 of the 4 installation jobs invoiced in December made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Wynnum factory solar and battery made a 17.4% job gross margin: 91.0 h of technician time ($6,188) and $2,300 of subcontractors on a $23,700 job. Jobs need 53.3% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

2 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about $4,476 between them on $39,200 of revenue. The biggest gap, Wynnum factory solar and battery: 17.4% gross margin, 17.6 points under the 35.0% target: about $4,183 on $23,700 of revenue in December. It's below the 53.3% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, December · Call-outs and repairs
47.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, November · Call-outs and repairs
49.0%
target 35.0%

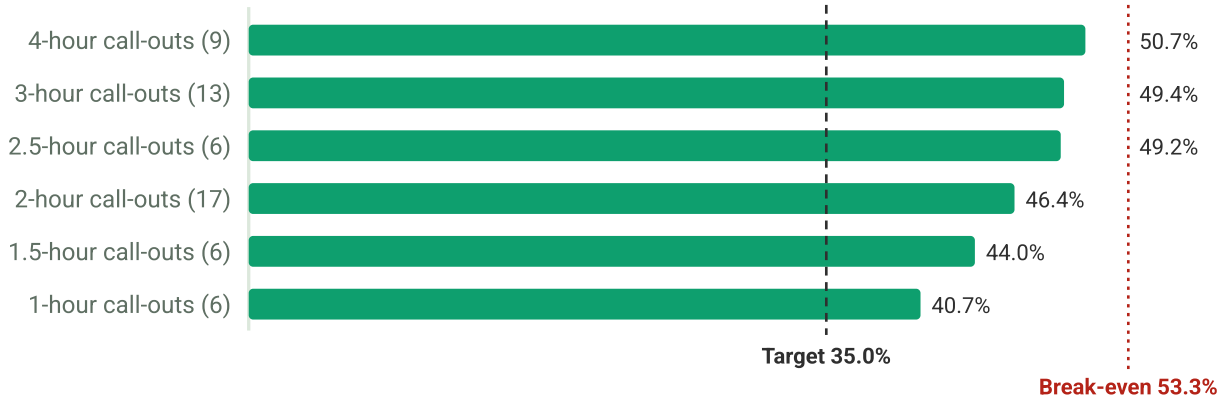
Gross margin jobs need to break even
53.3%
covers overheads and time not charged (December)

Technician time charged, December
$22,658
70.6% of call-out revenue

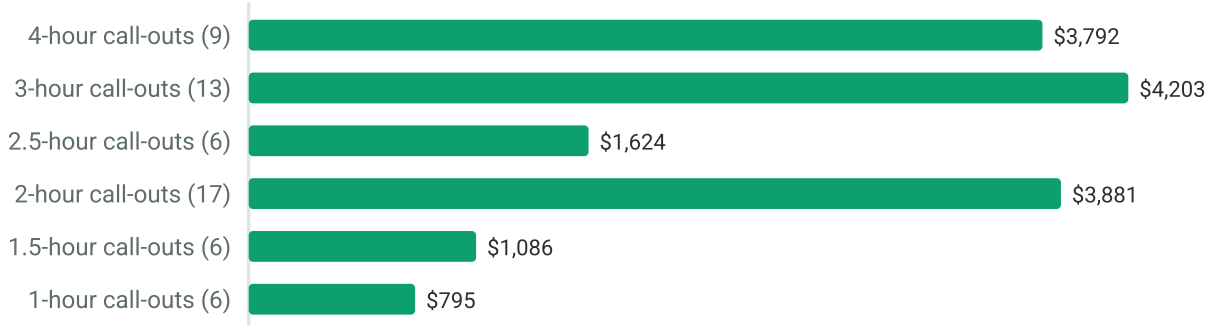
Materials charged, December
$9,425
$7,250 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, December 2025

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

57 call-outs in December billed $22,658 of technician time and $9,425 of materials ($7,250 at cost plus 30%), and made a 47.9% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 40.7% to 50.7% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

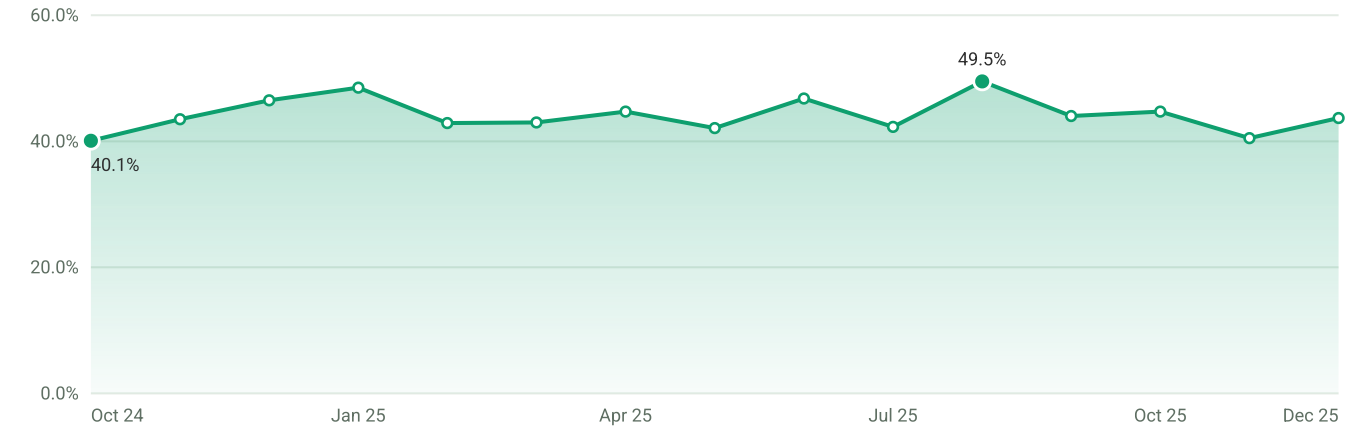
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 47.9% gross margin, 12.9 points over the 35.0% target ($4,152 ahead on $32,083 in December).

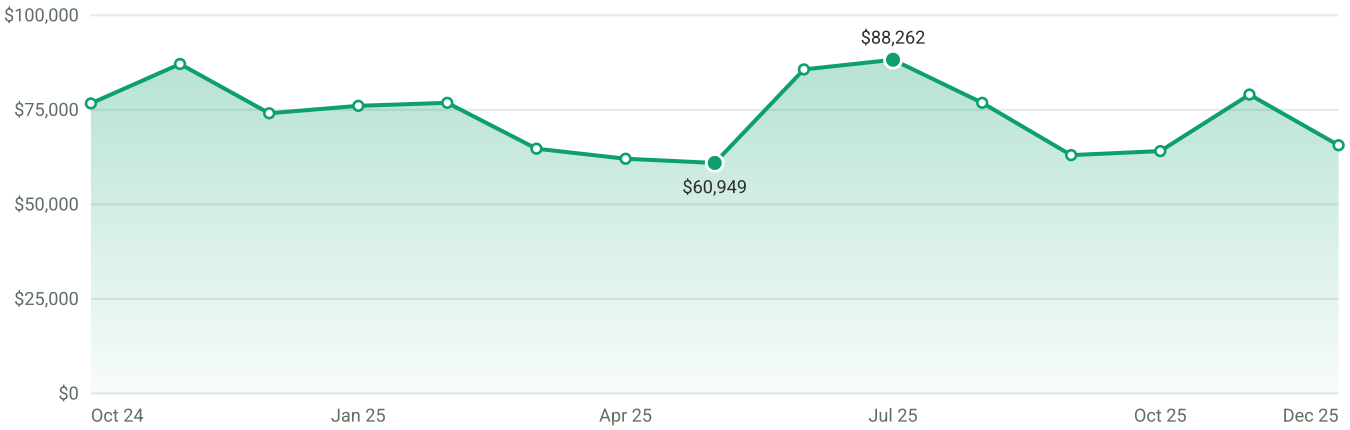
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.